

On-line remote back-up data storage

Price needs to be compressed

This Web-based back-up software does not require any storage space for the data at the user level. You only need to install the software and register yourself online at www.inforaksha.com. The software requires that your proxy or firewall (wherever applicable) should open ports 2773 or 2774.

Once the installation is complete, a disaster recovery disk should be prepared that stores the username, password, encryption method and encryption key. Backing up is a pretty easy process—you need to create a backup set by specifying the files to be backed up and naming the set. From then on, it automatically backs up the files on the server, depending on the frequency and time configured by the user.

Price: Rs 5,000 for a single user with 100 MB server space
Contact: InfoRaksha Netlinks Pvt Ltd
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Web site: www.inforaksha.com



Restore > Select Files for Restore will show you a list of the backup sets, and the day and time when they were taken. The files can be restored to either the original location or a new location on the hard drive. The location can be changed by going to **Restore > Redirect Restored Files** and then choosing the location.

Although the server storage is priced a little steep, the software does guarantee you peace of mind—provided you have a really high-speed Internet connection.

SPECIFICATIONS
Package Contents: Customised software CD, installation manual
System Requirements: Intel 486, Windows 98/Me/2000/NT/XP, 16 MB RAM, high-speed Internet/Network connection

On-line remote back-up data storage B	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of Use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Maxtor 250GB DiamondMax 16

So much to store

Storage solutions provider Maxtor has become the first company to introduce a 250 GB IDE hard disk, running at 5,400 rpm, and featuring the Ultra ATA/133 interface. The form factor is the same as any new disk drive. By jacking up the areal density using the latest technological innovations, manufacturers are



increasingly packing the standard drive with loads of storage capacity. Maxtor has maintained the spindle speed of the hard disk at a low 5,400 rpm, as compared to other high-capacity hard disks—even the buffer is maintained at the standard 2 MB. Although

the ATA/133 interface is supported, the low rpm definitely poses a bottleneck to transfer speeds. This is verified by the access time of the drive—11 ms, as compared to usual access times of 5 to 7 ms, which is the rated access time.

The hard disk is cheaper as compared to other 200 GB hard disks, primarily because it skimps on performance. Thus, it is suitable only for

Price: Rs 22,500
Contact: Cyberstar Infocom
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Web site: www.maxtor.com

those who are interested in finding a permanent solution to their storage problem, with no regards to the performance.

SPECIFICATIONS
250 GB internal hard drive, DMA/ATA-133 (Ultra) Fast interface, 3.5-inch form factor, 5,400 rpm spindle speed, 2 MB buffer, Dimensions: 1.02 x 4.02 x 5.75 inches, Weight: 600 grams

Maxtor 250GB DiamondMax 16 B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Neotech Keyboard

Too simple

The Neotech K-9856, a blue and silver keyboard, has a USB connector, thus cannot be used with older PCs. It features a rubber grip for stability, and the plastic pegs that are adjustable to three positions, so you can keep the board at an angle you prefer.

The keyboard has a regular layout with the hotkeys placed unobtrusively on the upper part of the board. The top row of regular keys has been made slightly smaller in order to accommodate the hotkeys. The keys do make a little noise when pressed. Besides, they don't depress much, making you doubt if the keystroke has been recognised by the system.

We also could not get the hotkeys to work on the Windows XP test bench, even though the software installation and key configuration

went smoothly. Also, the software did not install correctly with Windows 98, rendering the hotkeys useless.

The lack of



documentation also proved to be a major stumbling block.

This is a simple keyboard with a number of hot keys for speeding up frequently-used processes—if you can get them to work. It might appeal to those who are tired of looking at the conventional black and white keyboards.

SPECIFICATIONS
USB connectivity, 126 keys including 19 hotkeys, Windows 98/2000/XP compatible drivers

Neotech Keyboard B	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 999
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